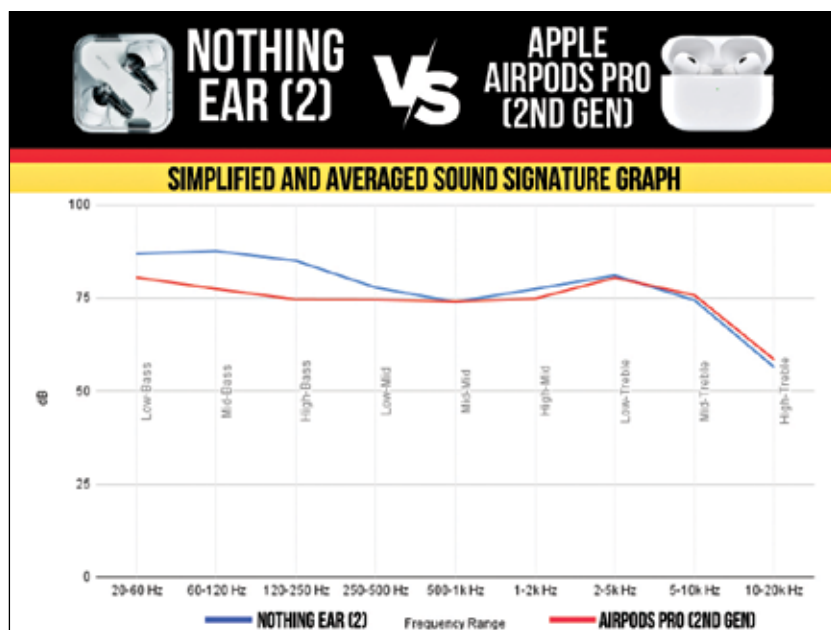




NOTHING EAR (2) VS APPLE AIRPODS PRO (2ND GEN)		
PRICE	₹ 9,999	₹ 26,900
SCORES		
BUILD	8.1	8.0
FEATURES	6.5	5.6
PERFORMANCE	7.7	7.8
OVERALL	7.5	7.2

lead. However, that lead was brought down when we factored in the charging consistency of these two devices.

The Apple AirPods Pro (2nd Generation) had a difference of about 4 to 6 per cent between the earbuds on many occasions. This is not just during the testing for this comparison. I have been using the same pair of AirPods for about 6 months now, and right since the first month, there has been a battery level consistency issue between the two buds. Nothing Ear (2) on the other hand, have

been used for a shorter period of time. However, from the get-go, they have shown better consistency when it comes to the retention of charge by the earbuds.

Both earbuds come with active noise cancellation (ANC) baked in. When comparing the ANC performance of the two earbuds, I factored in the price. The ANC on the Apple AirPods Pro (2nd Generation) is one of the best there is. Be it a noisy office or a traffic jam, or an aeroplane seat, you will get an uninterrupted listening experience.

On the Nothing Ear (2), coming from the Nothing Ear (1), there have been changes made which have improved the ANC on these earbuds. The difference in performance is very noticeable coming from the Nothing Ear (1). However, in extremely noisy environments like a traffic-filled road, you will be able to hear the sounds of the horns and other shrill sounds coming from the vehicles plying on the road. But for the price, the Nothing Ear (2) performs well.

Lastly, let's talk about the microphone. The microphone on the Nothing Ear (2) does a good job in isolating your sound. In moderately noisy environments, like a busy office, you will find your voice to be clear. However, when you move into noisier environments, you start getting some noise in, but the biggest letdown is the change in voice. In our testing, we found our voices to be slightly tinier.

On the Apple AirPods Pro (2nd Generation), this was never an issue. The microphone performed well, and on very rare occasions we did notice background noise becoming a hindrance to the speech of the person on the other side of the calls.

Winner - Apple AirPods Pro (2nd Generation)

Verdict

Getting ahead in two of the three categories, the Nothing Ear (2) proved to be the better value for money device when compared to the Apple AirPods Pro (2nd Generation). While being a great pair of earbuds, the Apple AirPods Pro (2nd Generation) are caught in a conundrum of the ecosystem preservation policy by Apple.

They bring in great sound, a great set of features, and an experience that is arguably the best in the industry. But, all that is there only in the ecosystem. As soon as you step out of it, you are hit with a gust of compatibility issues. Half the features are rendered useless, and there's practically no chance of customisation. The Nothing Ear (2) on the other hand, are versatile. Their app works seamlessly across platforms, they offer better connectivity and an overall better experience than the AirPods. **d**